

NICKY HAWKINS · PAINTER & DECORATOR

NH Estimator User Manual

A pocket guide to the paint-estimating app, from first measure to final invoice — measuring rooms, staircases and exteriors, pricing wallpaper and kitchen resprays, quoting through Xero, scheduling, and running the job on site.

App version 2.39.1 · Manual generated August 2026
Screenshots taken from the app with example data

NH Estimator is a phone-first web app for pricing decorating work. You walk round the property measuring up, and the app turns those measurements into a fully priced quote — labour, materials, markup, deposit and payment plan — which you can send straight into Xero. Once a quote is accepted, the same app schedules the job, tracks the materials and time you actually use on site, and builds the final invoice back into Xero when you're done.

This manual follows the life of a job in order: **set up → measure → quote → schedule → on site → invoice**. If you're brand new, read [Getting started](#) and [Measuring up](#) first — the rest will make sense as you need it.

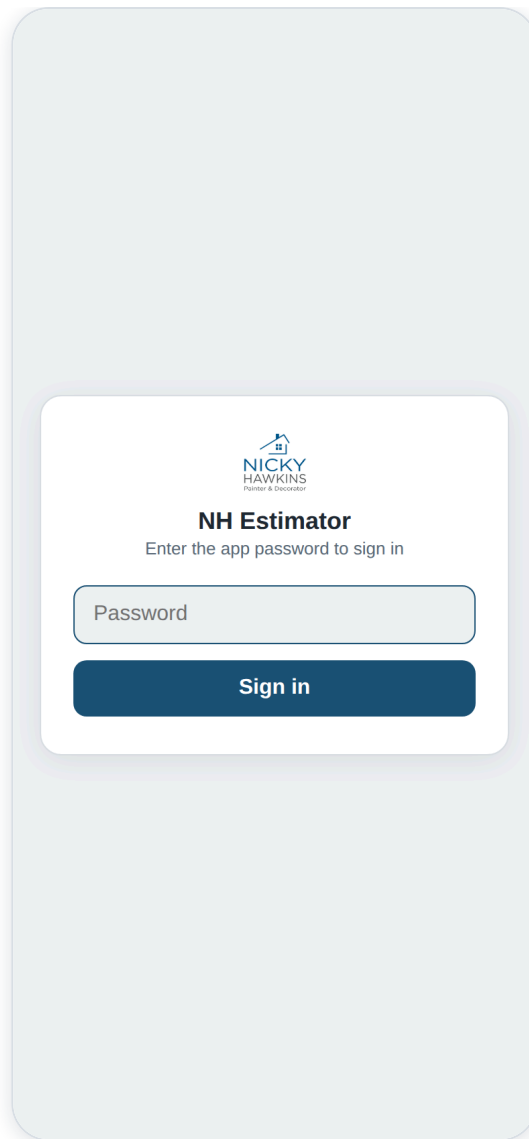
1. Getting started

Install it on your phone

The app lives at your own web address (the one on your Render account). It's designed to be **installed to your home screen** so it opens full-screen like a normal app:

- **iPhone:** open the app in Safari → tap the Share button → **Add to Home Screen**.
- **Android:** open it in Chrome → menu (⋮) → **Add to Home screen / Install app**.

If your copy of the app has a password set, you'll be asked for it the first time you open the app on a device — after that it stays signed in. If there's no password on your instance, guard the web address like you would any private page.



Connect Xero (one-off)

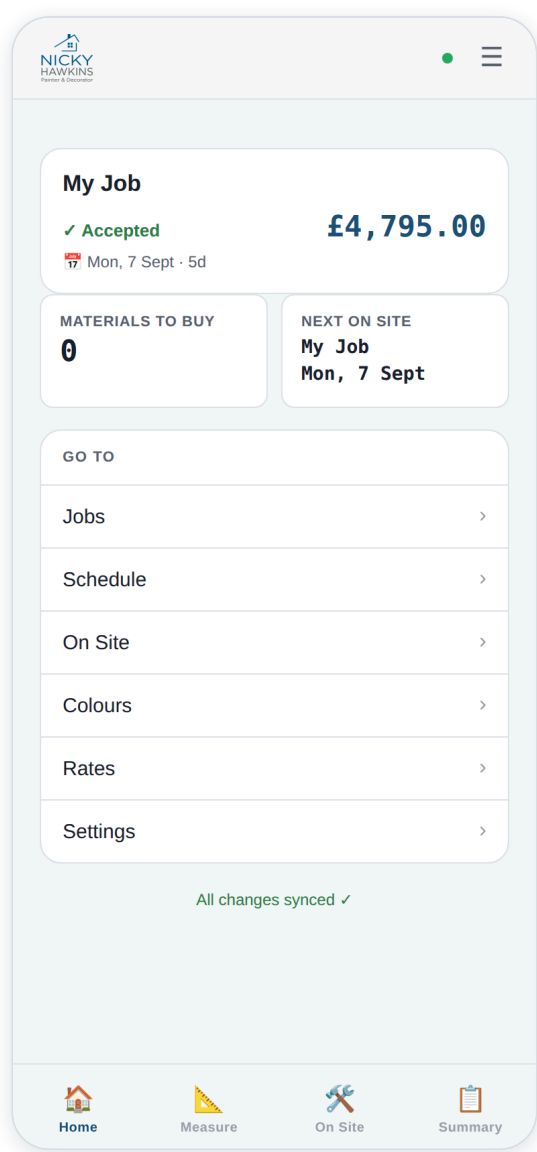
Almost everything works without Xero, but quoting and invoicing shine with it connected:

1. Open the menu (☰) → **Settings**.
2. Scroll to **Xero Integration** → tap **Connect Xero** and sign in.
3. Back in Settings, under **Materials (Xero Items)**, tap **Refresh from Xero** to pull in your paint products, then pick your default products (wall paint, ceiling, woodwork, primer, mist coat, masonry...). Every new room starts with these defaults, so set them once and forget them.
4. If you plan to record deposits through the app (see [Recording a deposit](#)), also pick a bank account under **Settings** → **Deposits (Xero)**.

Check your rates

The app ships with sensible defaults (day rate £300, 20% markup, 25% deposit, standard coverage rates), split across two screens off the menu: **Rates** holds the calculation tables, **Settings** holds everything else. Skim through both once and adjust anything that doesn't match how you price — every figure in a quote comes from these numbers.

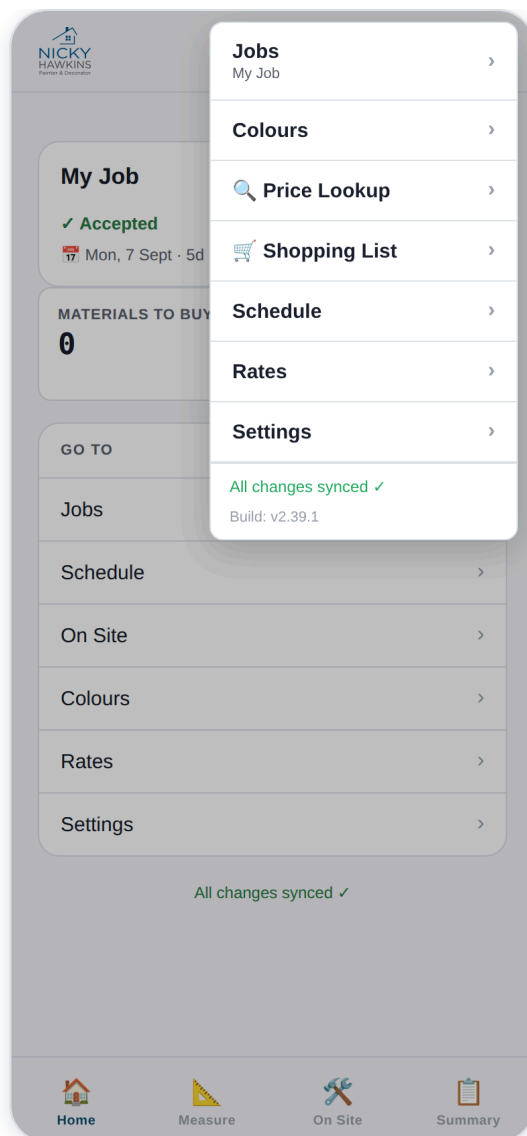
2. Finding your way around



The **Home** screen is your morning glance: the current job and its status, a **Materials to buy** count, what's **next on site**, and shortcut links. When something needs chasing — a quote that's gone unanswered too long, a finished job you haven't invoiced — it appears at the top of Home as an attention strip.

The **bottom bar** is always visible and follows the life of a job, left to right:

Tab	What it's for
 Home	Dashboard and reminders
 Measure	Everything measured for the current job — rooms, exterior items, kitchen, fitted units and custom lines
 On Site	Time, materials and variations while the job runs
 Summary	The priced quote, Xero, and job status



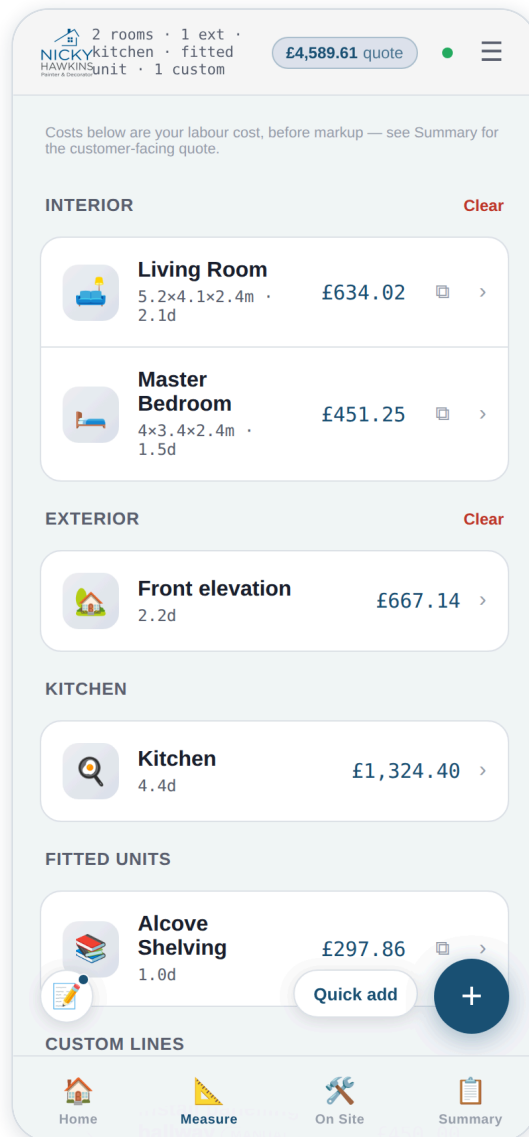
The **menu** (≡), top right on most screens, holds every other screen:

Item	What it's for
Jobs	Switch jobs, start a new one, import a pre-app Xero quote
Colours	The job's colour schedule and paint-ordering quantities
 Price Lookup	A till-check: search any Xero sales item for its price
 Shopping List	A running pick-up list, separate from any one job
Schedule	The job calendar
Rates	Every number behind a calculated price
Settings	Business details, Xero, backup, appearance

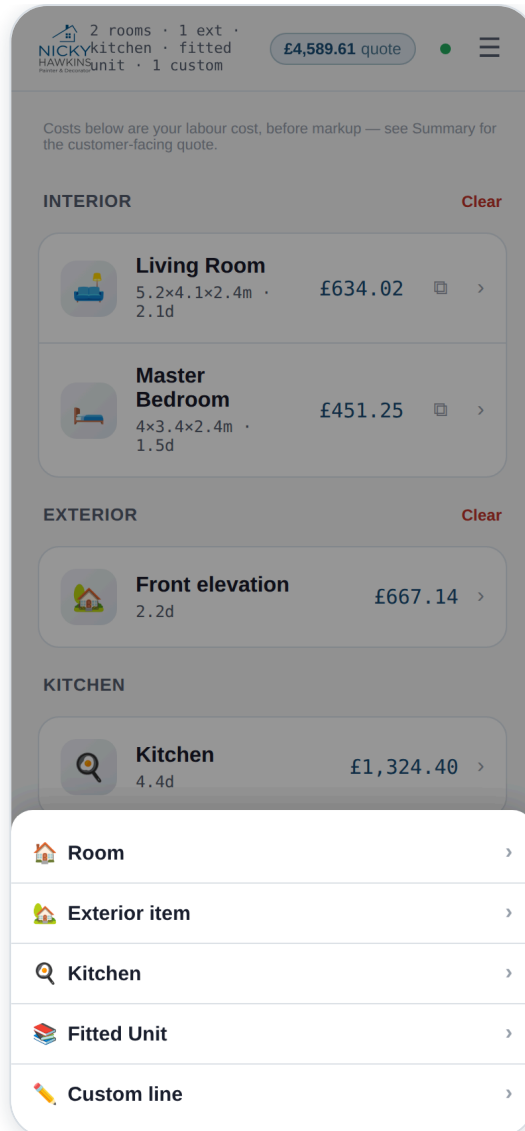
Below those, **↶ Undo** appears whenever there's a recent change on the current job you can undo (see [Materials & Undo](#)), followed by the sync line — "All changes synced ✓" means everything you've entered is safely on the server — and the build number, so you can confirm a deploy has actually reached your phone. Everything saves automatically as you type; there is no save button to forget.

3. Measuring up

Open  **Measure**. This screen lists everything measured for the current job — **Interior** rooms, **Exterior** items, the **Kitchen**, **Fitted Units** and **Custom Lines** — each showing its cost and estimated days at a glance. The figures on this screen are your *labour cost before markup* (the banner at the top says so); the chip in the top bar shows the customer-facing quote total, and Summary has the full customer-facing breakdown.



Tap the  **button** (bottom right) and choose what you're adding:



Quick add: walking a big house? Tap **Quick add** instead and just type the room names one after another — Living Room, Hall, Bedroom 1... — then go back round measuring each one on a second pass. Much faster than filling in a full form in every doorway.

Rooms and fitted units can also be **duplicated** — tap the  icon on their card in the Measure list. Everything copies: dimensions, coats, prep, colours and products, dropped in right below the original as "(copy)". This is the fast way to do bedrooms 2/3/4, or two matching alcove units either side of a chimney breast — measure one, copy it, change a couple of numbers. A copy always starts its own client sign-off from Pending (it never inherits the original's ✓), and on an accepted job it arrives flagged as a variation, same as anything else added after acceptance.

Adding a room

Edit Room Save

ROOM DETAILS

Room Name Living Room

Staircase / HSL
Hall, stairs & landing — swaps in staircase geometry below ☐

DIMENSIONS

Room shape
Perimeter / Segments for L-shapes & odd rooms Standard Perimeter Segments

Length metres 5.2

Width metres 4.1

Ceiling height metres 2.4

Sloped ceiling
Slope makes length × width wrong — type the measured ceiling area instead ☐

BAY WINDOW & ALCOVE/DORMER >

Home Measure On Site Summary

The form works top to bottom, and only the top matters for a basic room:

1. **Room Name** — e.g. "Living Room".
2. **Dimensions** — pick the **Room shape** first:
 - **Standard** — length × width × height, for a plain rectangular room (the default).
 - **Perimeter** — type the wall perimeter and ceiling height directly, plus the ceiling area, when the footprint doesn't reduce to L×W.
 - **Segments** — build the room from rectangular zones (each L×W) that sum into the wall run and ceiling area — made for L-shapes and rooms with big alcoves.

In any mode, the **Bay Window & Alcove/Dormer** add-ons cover the common awkward bits: bay window extra perimeter, alcove/dormer wall and ceiling area, and a sloped-ceiling toggle (type the measured ceiling area directly, since a slope makes length × width wrong). So loft rooms and bays no longer need fudged numbers. (The **Staircase / HSL** toggle above swaps this card for staircase geometry — see [Staircases](#) below.)

←

Edit Room

Save

Room shape

Perimeter / Segments for L-shapes & odd rooms

Standard Perimeter Segments

ROOM ZONES

rectangular zones (length × width) that make up the room — e.g. the two legs of an L-shape, or main room + alcove. Walls and ceiling both sum across zones

+ Add zone

Ceiling height

metres

2.4

Sloped ceiling

Slope makes length × width wrong — type the measured ceiling area instead

☐

BAY WINDOW & ALCOVE/DORMER

>

COATS

Walls

0 1 2 3

Ceiling

0 1 2 3

Woodwork

0 1 2 3

Spray walls

Home

Measure

On Site

Summary

3. **Coats** — walls, ceiling and woodwork each default to 2. Set any of them to 0 to skip that surface entirely (e.g. ceiling not being painted). Below the coat counts sit three independent **spray toggles** — one per surface:

NH Estimator — User Manual

9 / 44

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Room' screen in the NH Estimator app. At the top, there's a back arrow and the title 'Edit Room', and a 'Save' button on the right. The main content area has three sections for 'Walls', 'Ceiling', and 'Woodwork'. Each section has a quantity selector (0, 1, 2, 3) and a toggle switch. Below these are four sections: 'Spray walls', 'Spray ceiling', and 'Spray woodwork', each with a description and a toggle switch. At the bottom of the main content area are four sections: 'FEATURE WALL', 'EXCLUDED WALLS', 'DOORS & FRAMES', and 'EXTRAS', each with a right arrow. At the very bottom is a navigation bar with four icons: Home, Measure, On Site, and Summary.

Spray walls is off by default (also adds the spray sundries bump for the extra masking); **Spray ceiling** and **Spray woodwork** are on by default, since ceilings and woodwork are normally sprayed. A surface's toggle adds the Rates spraying uplift % to its litres on top of the standard or per-product rate — labour time is unchanged either way.

Then the optional sections, which you'll use as the room demands:

- **Feature Wall** — one wall in a different finish: paint, or wallpaper (standard, wide vinyl or mural).
- **Excluded Walls** — walls you're *not* painting (a tiled wall, wallpaper that's staying). Add its width × height and it's deducted.
- **Doors & Frames** — doors and their frames are priced as separate line items, each with its own quantity, coats and prep:

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Room' interface with a 'Save' button at the top right. It contains two main sections: 'DOOR' and 'FRAME'. Each section has a 'Qty' input field set to '2' and a 'Coats' selector set to '2' (with options 0, 1, 2, 3). Below these are several toggle options: 'Both sides' (disabled), 'Fire door (FD30/FD60)' (disabled), and 'Self-priming paint' (disabled). A 'Prep level' section shows 'Minimal' as the selected option among 'Minimal', 'Standard', 'Heavy', and 'Custom'. At the bottom is a navigation bar with icons for Home, Measure, On Site, and Summary.

Leave a Door or Frame's quantity at 0 to price just the other one. Per line you'll also find **Fire door** (an FD30/FD60 intumescent-compatible surcharge, edges included in the coverage calc), **ironmongery** (remove-and-refit, or mask-in-place — mutually exclusive), **Self-priming paint** (skips the primer coat for one extra topcoat instead — once the paint has a Coverage Rates entry in Rates with Self-priming set, that entry takes over and this toggle is replaced by a note), and **Both sides** (price the whole leaf as one line instead of just the face seen from this room — handy for a door between two painted rooms, split one face each).

- **Extras** — windows (m²), window sills and radiators. Each adds its own time and paint.
- **Wallpaper** — lining and finish paper for walls or ceiling, priced per roll with an automatic **rolls-to-order** count. Covered in detail in [Wallpaper](#) below.
- **Mist Coat** — for fresh plaster; tick walls and/or ceiling, with a manual area override for "only part of it is new plaster".
- **Panelling** — wall panelling by area with its own coats (up to 4), prep and colour, independent of the room's own settings.

- **Preparation** — Minimal / Standard / Heavy, or a custom percentage. This scales labour. **Making Good** adds a fixed £ amount for repairs.
- **Paint & Colour** — each surface takes your default product from Settings; override the product, colour band or colour here when a room is different.

Two cards at the bottom sum up what you've entered:

- **Preview** — the live estimated cost and time, updating as you type.
- **Paint Needed** — how many litres this room takes, per surface, at your coverage rates (with each surface's spray uplift already included, rounded up to the half litre):

Edit Room Save

Remove & refit ironmongery
Handles/hinges/locks taken off and refitted ☐

Mask ironmongery in place
Cheaper than removing — mutually exclusive with removing ☐

EXTRAS >

WALLPAPER >

MIST COAT >

PANELLING >

PREPARATION >

PAINT & COLOUR >

PREVIEW

Wall area	39.24 m ²
Ceiling area	21.32 m ²
Estimated cost	£634.02

Home Measure On Site Summary

These are the same figures Summary's materials list buys from — a feature wall in the room's own colour and product folds into the Walls line rather than getting its own row, since that's one tin of paint bought once.

Staircases (Hall, Stairs & Landing)

Stairwells are the hardest thing to measure by hand — big raking walls you can't get a tape across, hall and landing running into each other. The app does the geometry for you. Flick the **Staircase / HSL** toggle at the top of the room form and the Dimensions card is replaced with staircase geometry:

The screenshot shows the 'Add Room' screen in a mobile app. At the top, there's a back arrow and 'Add Room' text, and a 'Save' button. The screen is divided into several sections: 'ROOM DETAILS' with 'Room Name' set to 'Hall, Stairs' and a 'Staircase / HSL' toggle switch turned on; 'NUMBER OF FLOORS' with 'Floors' set to 2 (including ground floor); 'GROUND FLOOR HALL' with 'Length' (4.2 metres), 'Width' (1.9 metres), and 'Height' (2.4 metres); and 'STAIRCASE 1' with 'Stair walls' set to 1 (how many sides get painted). At the bottom is a navigation bar with icons for Home, Measure, On Site, and Summary.

Work down the cards:

1. **Number of Floors** — 1, 2 or 3 including the ground floor. A typical two-storey house is **2**: ground-floor hall, one staircase, first-floor landing. Choose 3 and a second staircase and landing appear.
2. **Ground Floor Hall** — plain length × width × height, like any room.
3. **Staircase 1** — this is where the app earns its keep:

The screenshot shows the 'Add Room' screen in the NH Estimator app. At the top, there is a back arrow, the title 'Add Room', and a 'Save' button. The screen is divided into two main sections: 'Stair walls' and '1ST FLOOR LANDING'.

Stair walls section:

- Stair walls:** how many sides get painted. A toggle switch is set to '1' (with '2' also visible).
- Steps:** count as you go up. Value: 13.
- Stair width:** metres — physical width of the stairs. Value: 0.9.
- Wall height at bottom:** metres. Value: 2.4.
- Riser:** default 220mm. Value: 0.22.
- Tread:** default 220mm. Value: 0.22.
- Top step:** metres — measure at the top, see diagram. Value: 0.25.

1ST FLOOR LANDING section:

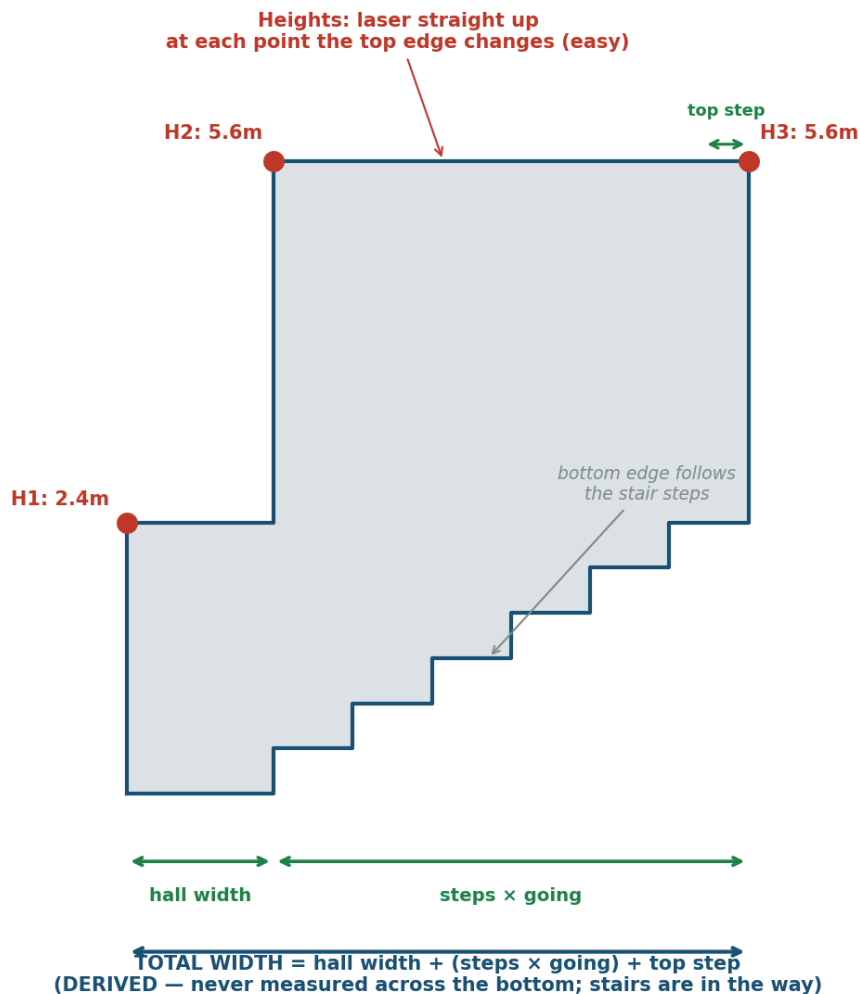
- Length:** metres. Value: 3.0.
- Width:** metres. Value: 1.9.
- Height:** metres. Value: 2.4.

At the bottom, there is a navigation bar with four icons: Home (house icon), Measure (triangle icon), On Site (wrench icon), and Summary (clipboard icon).

- **Stair walls** — how many sides of the staircase get painted (1 or 2).
- **Steps** — count them as you go up.
- **Stair width** — the physical width of the stairs.
- **Wall height at bottom** — floor to ceiling at the foot of the stairs.
- **Riser** and **Tread** — pre-filled with the standard 220 mm; only touch these on an unusual staircase.
- **Top step** — the one measurement people get wrong, so it has its own diagram:

WALL 1 — Large raking stair wall: DERIVE the width, MEASURE the heights

Width is built UP from the bottom (hall + steps), NOT measured across the top — the upstairs landing length overlaps the stairwell void and double-counts. This avoids that error.



The trick, as the diagram shows, is that the big raking stair wall's width is **derived, never measured**: hall width + (steps × going) + top step. Measuring across the top instead double-counts the stairwell void; measuring along the bottom is impossible because the stairs are in the way. You measure only the easy things — heights straight up with a laser — and the app builds the wall from the step geometry.

4. **1st Floor Landing** (and 2nd, for three floors) — plain length × width × height again.
5. **Staircase Details** — spindles, newel posts and their woodwork coats. These are priced per piece, with their own timings editable under Rates → Time Rates.

The **Staircase Areas** card at the bottom shows its working — so you can see exactly what you're pricing and sanity-check it against the space you're standing in:

←

Add Room

Save

PREPARATION

PAINT & COLOUR

STAIRCASE AREAS

Hall wall area	29.28 m ²
Stair 1 wall width derived — hall width + steps + top step	5.01 m
Staircase 1 walls	13.23 m ²
1st floor landing walls	23.52 m ²
Total ceiling area	13.68 m ²
Total wall area	66.03 m²
Woodwork (doors, frames & skirtings)	£125.71
Staircase woodwork	£240.45
Estimated cost (ex markup)	£821.53
Estimated time	2.74 days

PAINT NEEDED — estimated litres

Walls	10.5 L
Ceiling	2.5 L

Home

Measure

On Site

Summary

Here the derived stair wall width is 5.01 m (1.9 m hall + 13 steps × 0.22 m + 0.25 m top step), giving 13.23 m² of raking stair wall on top of the hall's 29.28 m² and the landing's 23.52 m² — a 66 m² job in total, priced at 2.74 days, without a tape measure going anywhere near the stairwell.

Wallpaper & rolls to order

Any room (including a staircase) can have wallpaper on the walls, the ceiling, or both. Open the **Wallpaper** section of the room form:

The screenshot shows the 'Add Room' screen of an app. At the top, there's a back arrow and 'Add Room' text, and a 'Save' button. The main content area has several sections:

- Walls:** A section with a note 'both can be on — e.g. line out then finish' and two buttons: 'Lining' and 'Finish'.
- Wall wallpaper labour:** A row showing '£780.00'.
- Rolls to order:** A section with a note 'does not feed the quote total — client buys the paper'.
- Roll length:** A field with '10.05' and a note 'metres — check the label'.
- Roll width:** A field with '0.53' and a note 'metres — check the label'.
- Pattern match:** Three buttons: 'No match', 'Straight' (selected), and 'Offset'.
- Pattern repeat:** A field with '32' and a note 'cm — off the roll label'.
- Spare roll:** A toggle switch that is turned on, with a note 'order one extra, just in case'.
- Drop length:** A row showing 'Lining 2.50 m · Finish 2.82 m'.
- Drops per roll / needed:** A row showing 'Lining 4 / 33 · Finish 3 / 33'.
- Rolls to order:** A row showing 'Lining 10 · Finish 12'.
- Ceiling:** A section with a note 'both can be on — e.g. line out then finish' and two buttons: 'Lining' and 'Finish'.

 At the bottom, there's a navigation bar with four icons: 'Home', 'Measure' (highlighted), 'On Site', and 'Summary'.

- **Lining / Finish** — tap either or both. Both on means "line out, then hang finish paper", and each is priced separately per roll (rates in Rates → Wallpaper Rates). The labour appears immediately.
- **Roll length / Roll width** — pre-filled with the standard 10.05 m × 0.53 m; check the label of the actual paper and adjust.
- **Pattern match** — *No match* (lining papers, plains), *Straight* or *Offset*. A pattern match wastes paper, and the calculation accounts for it.
- **Pattern repeat** — in cm, straight off the roll label.
- **Spare roll** — adds one extra to the order, just in case.

Below the inputs the app shows its working, batch-book style: the **drop length** (wall height plus trim allowance, lengthened to allow for the pattern repeat when there's a match), **drops per roll / drops needed**, and the bottom line — **Rolls to order**. Read that to the client off your phone.

Two things worth knowing:

- The rolls figure is a **buying guide, not a charge** — the labour feeds the quote; the client buys the paper — and the app deliberately doesn't supply it.

- On a staircase/HSL room, wallpaper labour automatically picks up the **staircase multiplier**. Ceilings get their own multiplier the same way.

Besides the standard roll calculation above, two other wallpaper types are available (feature wall only, under Rates → Wallpaper Rates for pricing): **Wide Vinyl** (commercial 137 cm material, priced per metre/area) and **Mural** (printed to the wall size, priced per m² or a flat fee).

Adding an exterior item

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Exterior' form in the NH Estimator app. The form is organized into sections with expandable headers. The 'LABEL' section contains a 'Description' field with a placeholder 'e.g. Front elevation, Rear fascias' and a button labeled 'Front elevat'. The 'MASONRY / RENDER' section includes an 'Area' field set to '48 m²', a 'Coats' field with options 1, 2, and 3, and two toggle switches for 'Textured render' and 'Spray render'. The 'FASCIAS & SOFFITS' section has a 'Length' field set to '14 linear metres' and a 'Coats' field with options 1, 2, and 3. The bottom navigation bar features icons for 'Home', 'Measure', 'On Site', and 'Summary'.

Exterior work is priced per *item* — typically one per elevation ("Front elevation", "Rear + gable") or per job type ("Fascias all round"). Each item is a menu of exterior work; fill in only what applies:

- **Masonry / Render** — area in m² and coats, with toggles for **textured render** (more paint, more time) and **spray render**.
- **Fascias & Soffits** — linear metres and coats.
- **Exterior Windows** — one row per matching group, with panes-per-window and a size band.

- **Exterior Doors & Frames** — same fire-door/ironmongery/self-priming options as interior doors, split the same way.
- **Garage Doors, Porch / Feature Door** — priced in days.
- **Sash Window Restoration** — prime & paint plus resin repairs, reglazing, draught-proofing, cords and beads, added per window.
- **Preparation and Making Good** — same idea as rooms.
- **Paint Colours** — one masonry colour and one exterior woodwork colour per item.

Access uplifts for 1st floor and 2nd floor+ work are applied per item automatically; the percentages live in Rates. Exterior paint litres are estimated from assumed areas per unit (window, sash, door, garage, fascia width) — calibrate these in **Rates → Exterior Paint Coverage & Areas** as real jobs prove them out.

Site notes

Tap the  **button** (bottom left of Measure) any time to jot job notes — access arrangements, things agreed on the doorstep, snags you spotted. Notes save automatically and stay with the job.

J. Smith Decor

2 rooms · 1 ext · kitchen
· fitted unit
· 1 custom

£4,589.61 quote

Costs below are your labour cost, before markup — see Summary for the customer-facing quote.

INTERIOR

Clear



Living Room
5.2×4.1×2.4m · 2.1d

£634.02

>



Master Bedroom
4×3.4×2.4m · 1.5d

£451.25

>

EXTERIOR

Clear



Front elevation
2.2d

£667.14

>

KITCHEN



Kitchen
4.4d

£1,324.40

>

FITTED UNITS

SITE NOTES

Done

Key under the pot by the side gate.
Client happy for spraying in the kitchen.
Crack above bay window needs filling — allowed for in prep.

NH Estimator — User Manual

19 / 44

4. Kitchen cabinet respray

On **Measure**, tap **+** → **Kitchen** to open the dedicated cabinet-spray calculator — one kitchen per job, saved automatically. Once it has anything in it, the kitchen appears as its own priced line in the Measure list and the quote.

The screenshot shows the 'Kitchen' calculator interface. At the top, there's a back arrow, the title 'Kitchen', a quote value of '£1,589.28', a green status dot, and a menu icon. Below this are several sections: 'COATS' with a note '— applies to every item below' and a 'Coat count' selector set to '2'; 'FACES' with a note '— applies to every counted item below' and a toggle for 'Outside faces only' (currently off); 'PREP' with a note '— applies to every counted item below' and a toggle for 'Strip original coating' (currently off); and a list of item counts: 'DOORS' (10), 'DRAWER FRONTS' (5), 'END PANELS' (2), and 'FILLERS' (empty). At the bottom is a 'LINEAR ITEMS' section with a note '— priced per metre, not per piece'. The bottom navigation bar has four icons: Home, Measure (active), On Site, and Summary.

- **Coat count** (1–4) applies to every item below.
- Tap open **Doors**, **Drawer Fronts**, **End Panels** and **Fillers** and enter how many of each size (Small / Medium / Large / X-Large). Each size has its own base price and per-coat price — tune them in Rates → Kitchen Rates. Each card shows its piece count on the header once collapsed, so you can shut them all and tally the kitchen at a glance.
- **Linear items** — cornices and plinths are priced per metre.
- **Carcass spraying** — toggle on to add a percentage uplift for spraying the cabinet interiors/carcasses.
- **Colour & Product** — pick the paint for the quote and materials list.

Two cards sit above the item counts and apply across everything below them:

Kitchen £938.28 quote

COATS — applies to every item below

Coat count: 1 **2** 3 4

FACES — applies to every counted item below

Outside faces only
Only the front of each piece is sprayed — halves doors, drawer fronts, end panels & fillers. Carcass spraying, cornices/plinths and stripping are unaffected ☒

PREP — applies to every counted item below

Strip original coating
Melamine/existing coating removal before spraying — adds prep time per item, based on the counts below ☐

DOORS 10 >

DRAWER FRONTS 5 >

END PANELS 2 >

FILLERS >

LINEAR ITEMS — priced per metre, not per piece

Home Measure On Site Summary

- **Outside faces only** — for jobs where only the fronts are being sprayed. Turn it on and doors, drawer fronts, end panels and fillers are all priced at **half** — the per-piece prices in Rates are whole-piece, both-faces figures, so half is one face. Carcass spraying, cornices/plinths and stripping deliberately stay at full price (the carcasses are the same surface either way; trim has one face to begin with), and the client's quote line reads "outside faces only" so the scope limit is on their copy too. Off by default, so nothing you've already quoted changes.
- **Strip original coating** — for spraying over melamine. Adds stripping time to every piece counted, at your day rate, worked out from the counts already entered — the line beneath the toggle shows the sum it priced so you can check it before it lands in the total. Off by default and the minutes-per-size are editable under Rates → Kitchen Rates.

5. Fitted units

+ → **Fitted Unit** on Measure — for bespoke built-ins: a bookcase or media unit with open shelving above and cabinet doors below. You can add several to one job, each auto-named "Fitted Unit N" (rename it — "Left alcove", "Media wall unit" — so multiple units read apart on the quote, materials and client view).

Fitted Unit £357.43 quote

UNIT — open shelving & cabinet doors, priced per shelf/bay/door

Name
shown on the quote breakdown, materials & client view — e.g. "Left alcove" Alcove 5

Bays
vertical sections 3

Height per bay
m — one shared height for every bay (fitted units are near-always a single consistent height — say if a per-bay height is ever needed). With depth & the bay widths below, drives the paint litres only 2.1

Depth
m — internal carcass depth, front to back, shared by every bay. Litres then use the real painted area per bay (back + both sides + top & bottom) and per shelf (top & underside), instead of the old flat guesses 0.35

Bay 1 width
m 0.6

Bay 2 width
m 1.2

Bay 3 width
m 0.6

Shelves
total across all bays, fixed area

Home Measure On Site Summary

Unlike the kitchen calculator's flat £ pricing, a fitted unit is priced in **minutes**, like rooms and doors, so it stacks properly into the day-rate maths:

- **Bays, Height per bay, Depth** — one shared height and depth for the whole unit (fitted units are near-always a consistent height); a width input appears per bay, so uneven layouts (a wide TV recess between narrower shelf bays) are no problem.
- **Shelves** — total across all bays, priced as a fixed spray time each (top, underside and front edge in one unit).
- **Cabinet doors** — priced at the interior door rate, **one face** by default (a built-in is normally painted from the front only). **Door size** scales this for cupboard-size ($\frac{1}{2}$) or wardrobe-size ($1\frac{1}{2} \times$) doors, and **Both sides** prices the whole leaf — doubling that unit's

door labour and litres — for units sprayed inside and out. Shelves and bay carcasses are unaffected by either.

- **Prep Level** — Bare/Primed (full prime + 2 coats) or Existing painted (light key-sand + topcoat, no primer bought).
- **Sprayed finish** — off by default; adds the Rates spraying uplift to the litres.
- **Complexity/Masking** — None / +10% / +20%, for recessed lighting, tight bays or electrics to mask off. Stacks on labour time before markup, same shape as the Commercial toggle.
- **Colour & Product** — defaults to your Settings woodwork topcoat.

The **Breakdown** card shows the priced result before markup, same as a room's Preview.

6. Custom line items

+ → **Custom line** on Measure — for one-off items that don't fit any pricing model: "Install panelling — £450", or "Extra sheet of ply — £40 × 2".

The screenshot shows the 'Add Custom Line' form in the NH Estimator app. At the top, there is a back arrow and the title 'Add Custom Line', with a 'Save' button on the right. Below the title, a section labeled 'CUSTOM LINE' with a subtitle '— manual description & price, no calculation behind it' contains the following fields:

- Description:** A text input field with the placeholder 'e.g. Install panelling to hallway' and a value 'Install pane'.
- Unit price:** A text input field with the placeholder '£ ex VAT, entered directly' and a value '450'.
- Quantity:** A text input field with the placeholder 'default 1' and a value '1'.
- Line total (ex markup):** A calculated field showing '£450.00'.

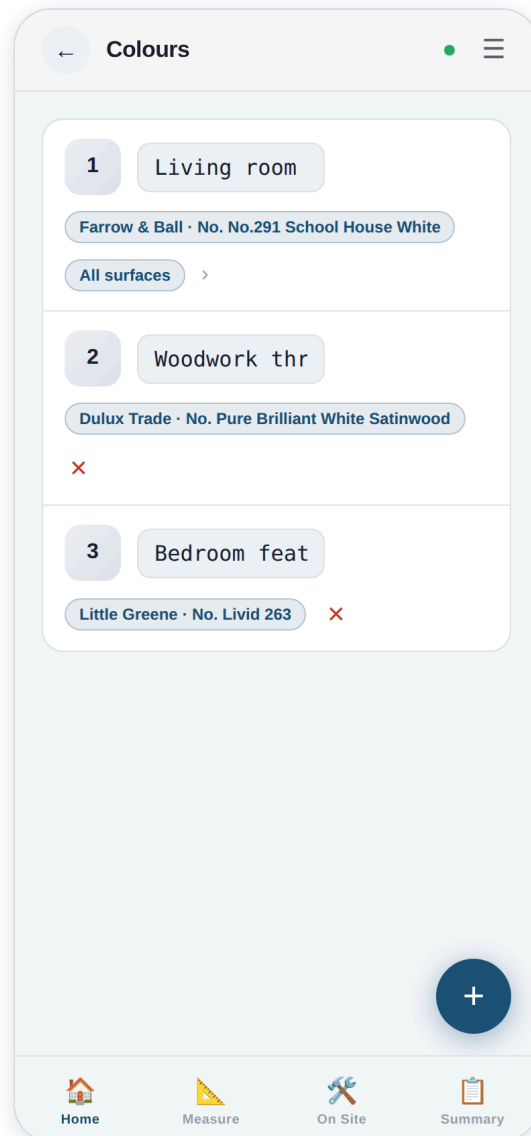
Below the 'CUSTOM LINE' section is a 'MARKUP' section with a toggle switch labeled 'Apply markup'. The toggle is currently turned on. Below the toggle, there is explanatory text: 'On = joins the quote's commercial/markup calculation like any other line. Off = the price above goes on the quote exactly as entered (margin already baked in)'.

At the bottom of the screen is a navigation bar with four icons and labels: 'Home' (house icon), 'Measure' (ruler icon), 'On Site' (wrench icon), and 'Summary' (clipboard icon).

Type a **Description**, a **Unit price** (ex VAT) and an optional **Quantity** (default 1). The **Apply markup** toggle decides how it behaves on the quote: on (the default) joins the commercial/markup calculation like any other line; off, the price goes onto the quote *exactly* as entered — for ad-hoc prices that already have your margin baked in. Custom lines sit in their own section on Measure with a MANUAL tag so they never read as a calculation, are fully editable and swipe-deletable, and flow through to the Summary breakdown, the client-facing Quote view, the Xero quote and the final invoice. No sundries % is added to them either way.

7. Colours

Menu (☰) → **Colours** — the job's paint and ordering screen. As you and the client settle on colours, note each one here: a label for where it goes, plus brand and colour name from the built-in library of over 1,200 colours across Farrow & Ball, Little Greene, Dulux, Dulux Heritage, Paint & Paper Library and RAL Classic.

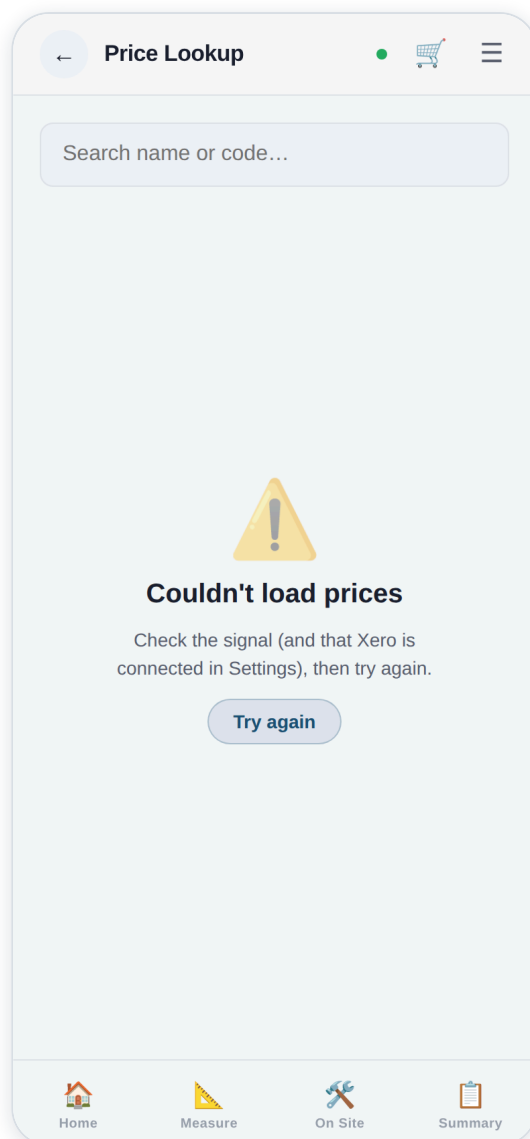


Numbered colour slots are what the room forms' colour chips point at — so "wall colour 1" in a room always means colour 1 on this list. Each colour number shows which rooms and surfaces use it and **how much paint to order** — the same calculation Summary uses, so the two can never disagree. Look here, not at Summary, when you're actually buying paint. Typing a colour name autocompletes from the library, filling in brand and code for the merchant; an unmatched colour can be saved to the library for next time, including the same name under a second brand.

8. Price Lookup & Shopping List

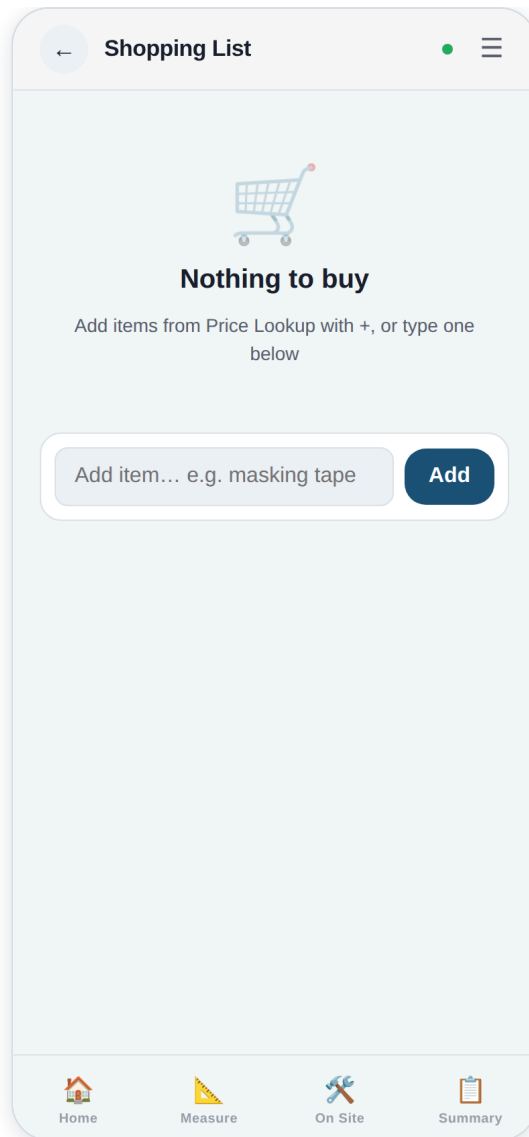
Two small tools off the menu, independent of any one job.

 **Price Lookup** searches every sales item in your Xero account by name or code and shows what it actually costs at the till — the inc-VAT price, with ex-VAT alongside. It's a read-only till check, not tied to any quote:



Tap the + on a result to add it straight to your Shopping List.

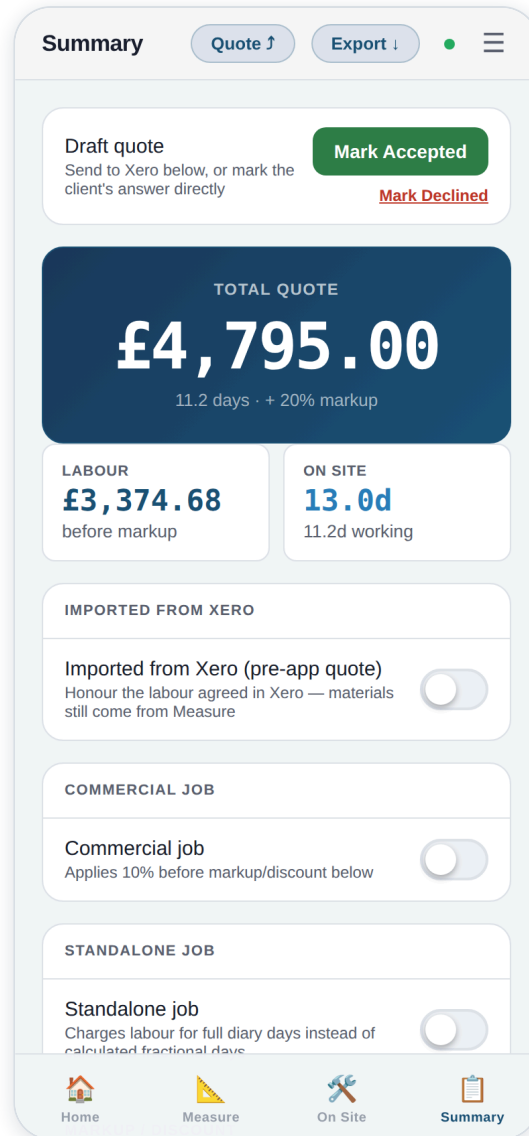
 **Shopping List** is a persistent, global pick-up list — not scoped to any one job, so a shop run can buy for whatever's on:



Items arrive from Price Lookup, or type one straight in ("masking tape") for anything that isn't a Xero item. Tick items off as you buy them and **Clear ticked** to reset for next time; items added from a job's materials carry that job's name as a tag, so the list says why something's on it.

9. The quote (Summary)

Open  **Summary** and the job becomes a priced quote:



Summary Quote ↑ Export ↓

Draft quote
Send to Xero below, or mark the client's answer directly

Mark Accepted
Mark Declined

TOTAL QUOTE

£4,795.00
11.2 days · + 20% markup

LABOUR
£3,374.68
before markup

ON SITE
13.0d
11.2d working

IMPORTED FROM XERO

Imported from Xero (pre-app quote)
Honour the labour agreed in Xero — materials still come from Measure

COMMERCIAL JOB

Commercial job
Applies 10% before markup/discount below

STANDALONE JOB

Standalone job
Charges labour for full diary days instead of calculated fractional days

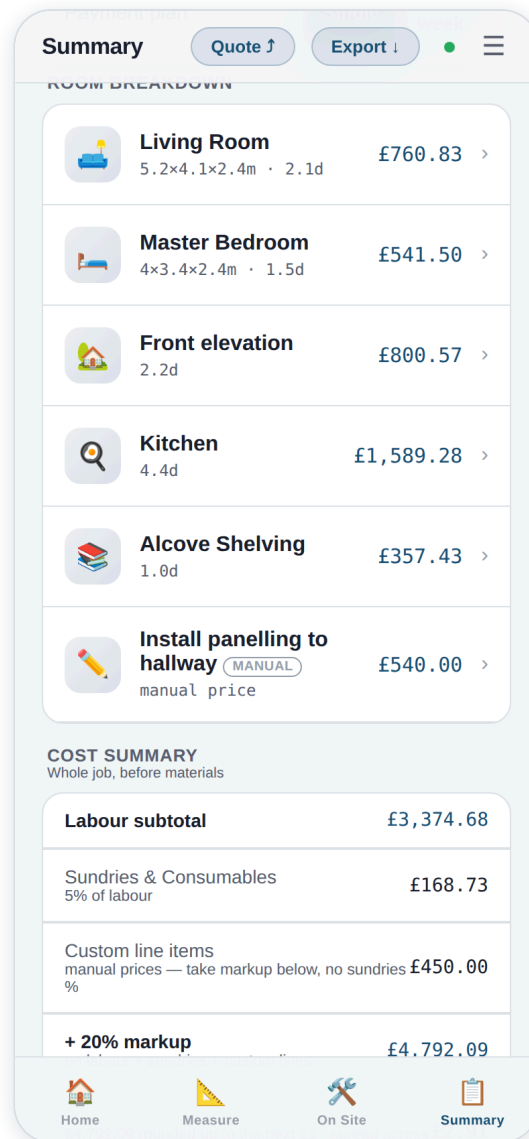
Home Measure On Site **Summary**

The hero card shows the **total quote**, days on site, and the markup applied. Below it:

- **Labour** (before markup) and **On Site days** at a glance.
- **Imported from Xero (pre-app quote)** — a toggle for jobs originally agreed directly in Xero before this app existed. Turn it on to honour that agreed labour figure as-is instead of the app's own room calculation; materials still come from Measure as normal. Leave it off for anything measured and priced in the app.
- **Commercial job** — a toggle that adds a percentage uplift (default 10%) before markup, for commercial rather than domestic work.
- **Standalone job** — for a job booked on its own, where 1.6 calculated days still blocks out 2 diary days: this toggle charges labour at whole diary days × your day rate (rounding up to a full or half day, per the setting in Rates). It never discounts — if the calculated labour already beats the rounded figure, nothing changes. Both figures stay visible on the quote maths, and the top-up flows through markup, deposit, Xero and the final invoice like any other labour. A job can be commercial, standalone, both or neither.

- **Markup / Discount** — this quote can override your default markup; enter a negative number for a discount.

Scroll further for the full breakdown — every room, exterior item, kitchen, fitted unit and custom line priced, labour subtotal, sundries, markup — followed by the **Materials** list: each paint totalled in litres and converted into tins to buy.



Materials & Undo

Materials are quoted as an estimate and — once the job runs — invoiced as used, so the list on Summary and On Site is the same list throughout a job's life. **Add Material** searches your Xero items (or free-text) for anything the calculation missed, and manually-added lines carry a **Chargeable** tickbox — off keeps a line as tracking-only, on puts it on the invoice. **Recalculate** re-pulls the calculated lines from the rooms without throwing away your own additions: anything you added yourself is kept and tagged "**added by you**", a quantity you've typed over is kept and tagged "**edited**" (with a **reset to N** link if you want the calculation's figure back), and if recalculating would drop something you edited by hand, you're asked first, by name.

Almost anything you do to the materials list — recalculating, deleting a line, changing a quantity, adding a line — can be undone. Look for an **UNDO** button on the confirmation message right after the change, ↶ **Undo** at the top of the Materials list, or ↶ **Undo** in the ≡ menu if you missed the moment. It remembers the last 10 changes on the current job; switching job or closing the app starts it fresh.

Once a quote is accepted, its figures freeze

Everything in this app is calculated from your current Rates and Settings — right up until a client says yes. The moment a quote is **Accepted**, the app takes one snapshot of every figure — every room's price, the materials, the totals — and from then on the client-facing views read that frozen record, not a fresh recalculation. So nudging a coverage rate or a day rate next month can't silently move the price on a job someone already agreed to.

If the job genuinely needs to change after acceptance — a variation, a correction — Summary shows the current **Accepted quote — Revision N** and an **Amend → revision N+1** link, which re-runs the calculation once and freezes a new snapshot. The old revision stays on record; nothing is overwritten.

Client-facing quote view

Quote ↑ (top bar, next to Export ↓) opens a branded, read-only one-page quote at customer-facing prices — room by room, colour schedule, payment terms and total, with your logo and business colours. It opens inside the app; tap **Save PDF** and it builds a real PDF file (as many pages as it needs) and hands it to your phone's share sheet — save it, email it straight to the client, or send it to a printer. It works with no signal, so you can produce a quote PDF standing in a house with no bars. It's regenerated live every time you open it, so it never shows stale figures, and doesn't touch Xero at all.

Recording a deposit

Once the job is **Accepted**, the status card carries the deposit line — unless you've turned off **Deposit required** (its own toggle, default on, for jobs that don't want one: a client who always pays, work squeezed in around a bigger job).

Summary [Quote ↑](#) [Export ↓](#) ● ☰

✓ **Accepted**
8/27/2026 · tracked in Materials > [Mark Completed](#)
[Move to Draft](#)

Starts Mon, 7 Sept · 5 days → Fri, 11 Sept
estimate now ~13 days, scheduled 5 [Reschedule](#) [Unschedule](#)

Received **1198.75** **08/27/2026** 📅

Note (option)
Plan says £1,198.75 — record what was **actually paid**, not what should have been.
[Save deposit](#) [Cancel](#)

Agreed figures — revision 1
frozen at acceptance · 27 Aug 2026. Rate changes since then do not move these numbers.
[Amend → revision 2](#)

ACCEPTED QUOTE — REVISION 1

LABOUR	
Living Room	£761.38
Master Bedroom	£541.89
Front elevation exterior	£801.15

Home Measure On Site **Summary**

1. **Record deposit** > — the amount is pre-filled from the quote's deposit figure; correct it to what was really paid, set the date the money arrived (matching your bank feed), add a note if you like, **Save deposit**.
2. **Sync to Xero** — creates it in Xero as Receive Money → Received as Prepayment, against the bank account chosen in Settings. **Don't also enter it in Xero yourself** — doing both double-counts the money against your bank feed.
3. **Apply it to the invoice in Xero** when you raise the invoice, exactly as before — the app can't do this step, since Xero won't let a payment be applied to a still-draft invoice.

The line then shows where things stand — *not in Xero yet*, *in Xero · unallocated*, or *in Xero · allocated* ✓ — read back from Xero, which stays the boss: void or delete the deposit there and the app notices and stops saying it's synced. A failed sync loses nothing — the deposit stays recorded, the line turns red with the reason, and **Try again** is safe. Fixing a mistake (a typo, a refund) is done in Xero, not here — the app never edits or deletes a deposit that's already landed.

Sending to Xero

Expand the **client panel** at the top of Summary:

1. **Client name** — start typing and existing Xero contacts autocomplete; picking one fills phone, email and address into blank fields only (anything you've already typed wins). **Sync to Xero** pushes the app's details the other way.
2. **Street address** autocompletes as you type; picking a suggestion fills street, town and postcode.
3. Add a **Reference** if you use them.
4. Tap **Send to Xero**. The quote is created in Xero, ready to send to the client from there, and the job's status becomes **Quoted**.

If you edit the job afterwards, the button becomes "**Update quote Q-*nnn* in Xero**" so re-sending updates the *same* quote — with a "Send as a NEW quote instead" option when you genuinely want a second version. Answers given in Xero flow back into the app when you next open it; an answer given in the app always wins.

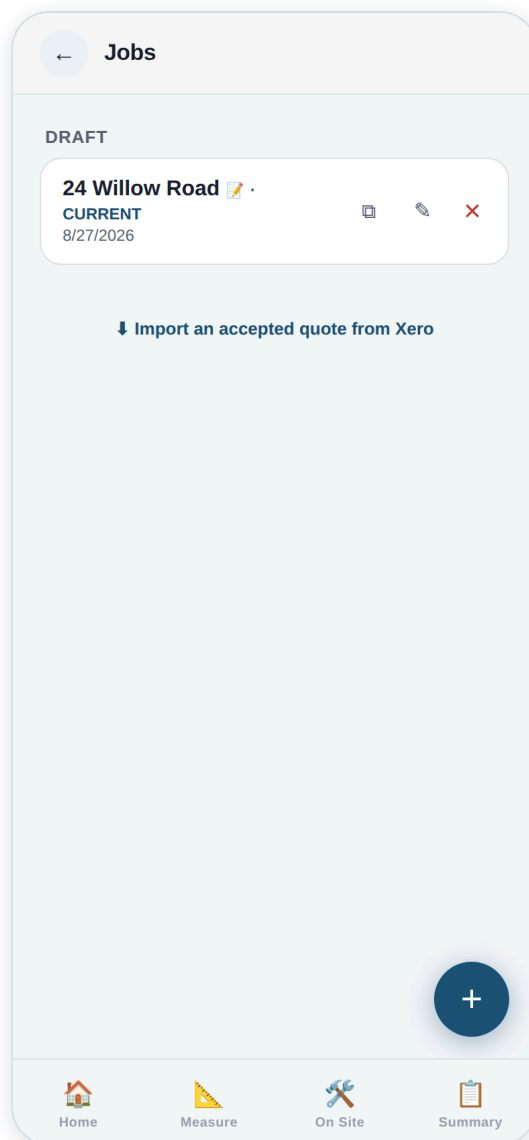
When the client answers

- **Mark Accepted** — the job moves to Accepted (synced to Xero), its figures freeze (see above), and scheduling and On Site tracking unlock.
- **Mark Declined** — the job files itself away under Declined.

Quotes that sit unanswered longer than your "chase quotes after" setting (default 14 days) pop up on Home so nothing slips.

10. Jobs

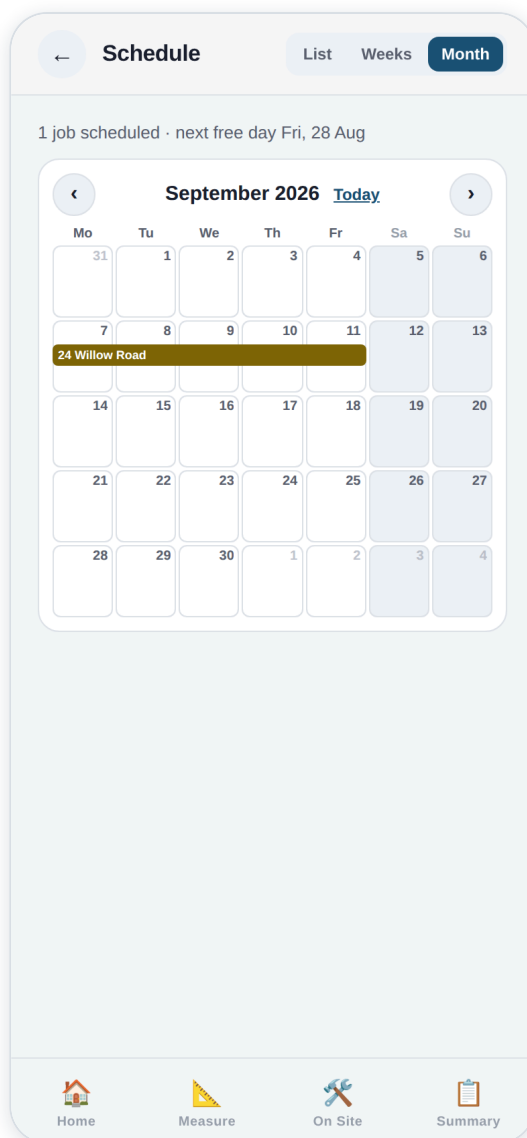
Menu (≡) → **Jobs**. The app holds any number of jobs; the one you're working on is marked **CURRENT**, and everything on Measure, Kitchen, Summary and On Site belongs to it. Tap another job to switch. Rates and Settings are global — they apply to every job.



- Jobs group by status: **Draft** → **Quoted** → **Accepted / Declined** → **Completed** → **Invoiced**.
- **+** starts a new job.  duplicates a job as a quick template (notes aren't copied). Each job is fully separate — its own rooms, kitchen, colours and materials.
- **Import an accepted quote from Xero** — took the job on before the app existed? Import the Xero quote and it becomes a job here, with the agreed price as the record (adjustable via the **Agreed figures** card, or the **Imported from Xero** toggle on Summary — see [The quote](#)). If a listed quote actually belongs to a job already in the app, use **"Already a job in the app? Link it >"** instead of importing a duplicate.

11. Schedule

Menu (☰) → **Schedule** — or tap **Schedule** > on an accepted job's Summary, which offers the next free slot automatically.



- Switch between **List**, **Weeks** and **Month** views. Jobs appear as coloured bars across their booked days; UK bank holidays are marked, and weekends are greyed out unless you've turned on **Work Saturdays** in Rates → Scheduling.
- **Tap a job's bar** → Open job, **Move start date** (then tap the new day), or Unschedule.
- **Tap an empty day** → start a job there, or **block days** for holidays and time off.
- The header tells you your **next free day** at all times.

A one-off day out of the ordinary, without changing anything globally: tap the day itself → **start a job here** (or move a job there), and the confirm tells you what switches on — a Saturday turns on "Saturdays for this job only", a Sunday or bank holiday turns on "Every day for this job only". From an accepted job's own **Schedule** > form, the same idea is the **Days worked** picker (Usual / + Saturdays / Every day), which switches itself if you pick such a start date. Automatic slot suggestions still only ever offer your usual working days, and your own blocked days always win.

See jobs in your phone calendar: Rates → Scheduling → turn on **Calendar feed**, then tap the link to copy it and subscribe in your calendar app. Booked jobs then appear alongside everything else in your life.

12. On Site — running the job

Once a job is accepted, the 🏠 **On Site** tab is your day-to-day companion:

The screenshot shows the 'On Site' mobile app interface for a job titled '24 Willow Road'. At the top, there's a header with 'On Site' and an 'Invoice >' button. Below the header, the job title '24 Willow Road' is displayed with a status 'Accepted' and a date 'Mon, 7 Sept · 5d'. A green 'Mark Completed' button is next to it. A table shows financial data: Estimated (£0.00), Actual (so far) (£0.00), and Variance (£0.00), with a note 'Everything ticked off'. The 'TIME ON SITE' section shows 'No days logged yet · estimated ~13 on site' and a '+ Log today (full day)' button, with a link to 'Log a different day'. The 'MATERIALS' section states 'No materials yet. Recalculate the snapshot on Summary, or add what you bought below.' The 'ADD MATERIAL THE ESTIMATE MISSED' section has input fields for 'Product' (with a search button), 'Description' (with an example 'e.g. Extra r'), and 'Colour' (with a dropdown menu showing 'No colour'). At the bottom is a navigation bar with icons for Home, Measure, On Site (active), and Summary.

- **Estimated vs Actual** — the card at the top tracks what the materials are really costing against what you quoted, with the variance.
- **Time on Site** — tap **+ Log today (full day)** at the end of each day (or *Log a different day* to back-fill). This builds the true labour record for the job.
- **Materials** — the quote's materials list becomes a shopping list. Tick items off as you buy them, and correct quantities/prices to what you actually paid — see [Materials & Undo](#) for how edits and Recalculate interact, and Undo if something goes wrong.
- **Add material the estimate missed** — extra sundries or a forgotten tin: search the product, set the price, done.
- **Variations** — the client asks for "just one more room" mid-job? Add the room (or exterior item, fitted unit) on Measure and flick its **Variation** toggle. It's priced with the same engine but kept separate from the accepted quote, and appears in its own Variations card here. Each variation carries a status — tap ✓ **Approved by client** to record their yes

(with an optional note; the date is stamped automatically), or mark one Declined to drop it from the totals and the final invoice while keeping the record. Anything still Pending gets called out before the final invoice will let it through.

- **Invoice** > (top right) shows the materials list formatted for invoicing, with a **Copy** button.

When the work's done, tap **Mark Completed** — the job moves on, and Home reminds you it needs invoicing until you do.

13. The final invoice

On a **Completed** job, On Site shows **Build final invoice**. The builder assembles the whole money story in one list:

- labour **as quoted** (the frozen accepted figure, not the hours it took),
- plus **approved variations**,
- plus the **actual materials** used (from your ticked-off list),
- minus any **deposit already recorded and synced to Xero**.

Review the lines, adjust anything, then send — the app writes **one draft invoice into Xero** and marks the job **Invoiced**. You approve and send the invoice from Xero as usual, so nothing goes to the client without your say-so. Applying the recorded deposit to this invoice, once it exists in Xero, is still done in Xero.

Once a job is Invoiced, Summary shows a read-only **Job Profitability** card telling three separate stories: **Billing** (quoted vs invoiced, with a note if they differ), **Schedule** (days quoted vs days actually logged), and **Materials** (quoted materials vs the real trade cost of what was used, with your markup on materials banked as its own figure). It's reference only — nothing here feeds back into pricing.

14. Rates

Menu (☰) → **Rates** — every number the calculator uses, grouped by what it prices. A change here applies to every future calculation, and reprices any open (un-accepted) draft immediately — accepted quotes are unaffected, since **their figures are already frozen**.

Rates

The figures behind every calculated price. Business settings — day rate, markup, Xero, backup — live on [Settings >](#)

PAINT COVERAGE

How many m² a litre covers — the standard rates, the per-product overrides that beat them, and the assumed areas behind exterior litres.

COVERAGE RATES

Wall Emulsion

m² per litre — rolled

13

Spraying uplift

% extra litres when a surface's Spray toggle is on (walls off, ceiling & woodwork on by default; fitted unit has its own) — applied on top of the standard or per-product rate, one global figure rather than a sprayed rate per product

30

Ceiling Emulsion

m² per litre — un-sprayed base; rooms' Spray ceiling toggle (on by default) adds the uplift below on top

17

Gloss / Satinwood

m² per litre — un-sprayed base; rooms' Spray woodwork toggle (on by default) adds the uplift below on top

9

Mist Coat

m² per litre — thinned product

15

Panelling

m² per litre per coat — draft default, check against your usual product

8

Home

Measure

On Site

Summary

Section	Card	What's in it
Paint Coverage	Coverage Rates	Standard m ² /litre per surface, the spraying uplift %, and per-product rates that beat the standard figure for a specific paint range
Paint Coverage	Exterior Paint Coverage & Areas	Assumed areas and coverages behind exterior litres
Labour Times	Time Rates	Minutes per m ² (or per item) for every surface, doors/frames, sills, mist, panelling, staircase parts
Labour Times	Exterior Rates	Minutes per coat for masonry, fascias, windows, doors, garage, sash extras, access uplifts
Item & Job-Type	Doors & Frames	Paintable areas per face, fire-door surcharge, ironmongery prices
Item & Job-Type	Wallpaper Rates	Per-roll rates, ceiling/staircase multipliers, minimum price, wide vinyl & mural rates
Item & Job-Type	Kitchen Rates	The full price matrix per item type × size, linear rates, carcass %, strip-original-coating minutes
Item & Job-Type	Fitted Unit / Shelving	Shelf and bay spray times, fallback areas behind fitted-unit litres
Scheduling	Scheduling	Daily overhead, schedule buffer, Work Saturdays, bank-holiday region, calendar feed

Calibrate as you go: after a few jobs, compare the logged time and actual materials on On Site with what was estimated, and nudge the time and coverage rates here. The estimates get sharper with every job.

15. Settings

Menu (≡) → **Settings**. Everything that isn't a calculation rate lives here: your business identity, pricing defaults, Xero, and backup.

Settings

BUSINESS

Business name

shown in the app header, on the login screen and in the calendar feed

e.g. J.

Logo

optional — shown instead of the name in the header

Upload...

PRICING

Day Rate

£ per day

300

Hours Per Day

7

Markup

%

20

Commercial job adjustment

% — default when a quote's Commercial job toggle is on, applied before markup/discount

10

Standalone job rounding

when a quote's Standalone job toggle is on, diary days round up to this

Full day

Sundries & Consumables

% of labour, before markup

5

Spray sundries bump

Home

Measure

On Site

Summary

Section	What's in it
Business	Your business name and logo — shown in the app header, on the sign-in screen and in the calendar feed
Pricing	Day rate, hours per day, markup %, sundries %, spray sundries bump, deposit %, commercial job adjustment, standalone-job rounding (full or half days), and how many days before an unanswered quote gets flagged
Deposits (Xero)	The bank account a recorded deposit lands in, and the account code it posts to
Xero Integration	Connect / disconnect
Materials (Xero Items)	Refresh your product list from Xero and set the default product for each role
Quote & Invoice Text	The per-job-type wording templates for quotes and final invoices
Appearance	Light / Dark / Auto theme (this device only)
Backup	Export and import everything — see below

16. Backups

Settings → **Backup**:

- **Export everything** downloads a single JSON file containing every job, room, setting and colour. Do this regularly — Home will nag you when the last backup is getting old.
- **Import backup** restores from a file, adding to what's already there — imported jobs get fresh identities, so it can never overwrite existing data. Restoring settings is a separate opt-in on the import preview, since it's the one thing an import *can* overwrite.

17. Tips & troubleshooting

The dot in the top bar is your sync status: green = everything saved to the server, amber = saving now, red = offline. If you lose signal mid-measure, keep working — changes are kept on your phone ("Offline — N changes queued on this phone") and pushed up when the connection returns; the menu's sync line confirms with "All changes synced ✓".

A price looks wrong? Work backwards: room Preview → Summary breakdown → Rates. The calculation is always $areas \times time\ rates \times day\ rate$, plus $areas \div coverage = litres \rightarrow tins$, plus sundries and markup. One of those numbers will be the culprit — usually a coverage or time rate that doesn't match how you actually work. If the job is already **Accepted**, remember its figures are frozen — a rate change won't move it; you'd need **Amend → revision N+1** on Summary.

Xero button not working? Tokens occasionally expire for good if the app hasn't talked to Xero in a long while. Settings → Disconnect Xero → Connect Xero puts it right in under a minute.

Sent a quote, then client wants changes? Just edit the rooms and hit **Update quote Q-
nnn in Xero** on Summary — same quote number, new figures.

Extra work mid-job? Always add it as a **Variation** rather than editing the accepted rooms — the original quote stays honest, and the extra shows separately on the final invoice where the client expects to see it.

Recording a deposit but the option's greyed out? A linked Xero contact is required before you can sync to Xero — the app will point you at Sync to Xero on the client details. You can still record the deposit locally in the meantime.

The build number at the bottom of the ☰ menu is how you check a new version has actually reached your phone after a deploy.

Manual for NH Estimator v2.39.1. Screenshots taken from the app with example data.

Keeping this manual up to date: edit this file, then run `npm run build:manual` to regenerate the PDF edition (`NH-Estimator-User-Manual.pdf`) and commit both together. The cover picks up the app version and date automatically.